EVIDENCE · LEDGER · STRUCTURE

kpi

Executive KPI system — one base, five layout modifiers.

Four tiles the eye sweeps in one pass.

4

tiles per row

THE CEILING ON PLAN

8

words per tile

SOFT BUDGET BOARD

5s

scan time

THE TARGET ON PLAN

0

prose sentences

ALLOWED HERE AUDIT

attention flags the tile that misses.

1

tile flagged

THE MISS ATTENTION

3

tiles steady

FOR CONTEXT ON PLAN

0

alarms hidden

HONESTY BOARD

4

tiles total

THE ROW ON PLAN

KPI OPS

ops reads the tiles against SLOs.

99.9%
the SLO frame
TARGET LINE SLO

4
tiles per row
UNCHANGED ON PLAN

1
breach shown
NEVER HIDDEN OPS

30d
the window
ROLLING SLO

KPI COMPLIANCE

compliance tallies findings per framework.

0 open findings

THE GOAL CLEAN

4 frameworks tracked

ONE ROW AUDIT

1 in remediation

DATED WATCH

KPI TRAJECTORY

trajectory pairs each tile with its delta.

+9%

the delta leads

VS PLAN UP

4

tiles still rule

PER ROW ON PLAN

−2

down is shown

NOT SPUN HONEST

spotlight gives one tile double width.

1

tile promoted

the headline SPOTLIGHT

2

support tiles

BESIDE IT ON PLAN

0

competing heroes

ONE ONLY RULE

Four tiles at full word weight.

4

the grid's seat count

A FIFTH NEVER RENDERS MAX

14

words per tile, the budget

SPENDS THE ALLOWANCE BUDGET

1

line per label

WRAPPING ENDS THE SCAN RULE

2

slides beat one crowd

SPLIT PAST THIS ADVICE

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ALLOWED HERE AUDIT

When NOT to reach for kpi.

Decorative pills without status semantics

The pills read as status, not freeform tags. Status color is assigned by each KPI's row position within the modifier — the engine never reads the pill text — so reserve them for the status vocabulary the position implies (`On plan`, `At risk`, `Breaching`, `Compliant`, `Remediating`). Arbitrary labels land a color that has nothing to do with the words.

When NOT to reach for kpi.

A fifth metric — or a fourth that is not terse

The supports divide whatever the title and eyebrow leave them, so count trades against label length. Measured at a **wide** @size — the box a deck is authored in, and the one where nothing paginates past the budget: three is the allowance, and a short label plus a target line fits up to a two-line title, with or without an eyebrow. A fourth needs everything terse — one status pill, no eyebrow, a one-line title. A fifth fits at no label length. Past that the ledger spills, and the export clips it and names the page — nothing shrinks silently to make room. Split across slides, or use `stats`, which drops the targets and pills and holds more rows. (A portrait or square deck paginates instead of clipping, so a long ledger there is divided into a run rather than cut.)

When NOT to reach for kpi.

Reaching for attention or spotlight to carry a fifth metric

`attention` highlights the metric that needs the room; `spotlight` monumentalizes one number. Both spend most of the stage on a single tile, so past four the hierarchy they exist to create collapses — split into two slides rather than crowding the hero.

No targets, no trends

If the KPIs carry only current values, the slide is a stats row, not a kpi dashboard. Use stats and reclaim the room.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`stats` — metric row without targets or status pills

`big-number` — a single number is the whole argument

`split-panel` — one KPI with a paragraph of supporting prose

`progress` — completion percentages across parallel workstreams

`timeline-list` — milestones in time, not metrics at a moment